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FRIDAY, OCTOBER 30, 2026

Now who makes the clean getaway?

CHRISTOPHER MUTHER

COMMENTARY

Airbnb guests can skip those long checklists, and the hosts aren't happy about it

Is asking a guest to wash their own dishes a step too far?

Airbnb says it is, and last week announced new rules taking effect Nov. 20, stating that hosts can no longer require guests to strip bedsheets, do laundry, wash and put away dishes, or haul trash off-site.

Hosts who rent their home via the homestay website say it's perfectly reasonable to ask guests to do these chores while still imposing cleaning fees. One superhost says they are "the most basic component of a self-catering stay."

"Airbnb is forgetting its founding principles," said Harry Newington, an Airbnb superhost who started a petition on Change.org with currently more than 20,000 signatures to protest the changes.

"These were to encourage hosts to allow guests into their homes, for those guests to respect the home they're in, and, in return, to experience a homely environment that is distinct from a hotel."

Now a $100 billion company, it's long past its days as a cool service-economy business. The company, so big that it's now being blamed for high rents and housing shortages in several European

AIRBNB, Page A6



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

A crowd waited for the auction of the tower to begin earlier in the week. Rockpoint Group was the only bidder.

Second time's the charm for investor

After default, buys tower again, for far less at auction

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

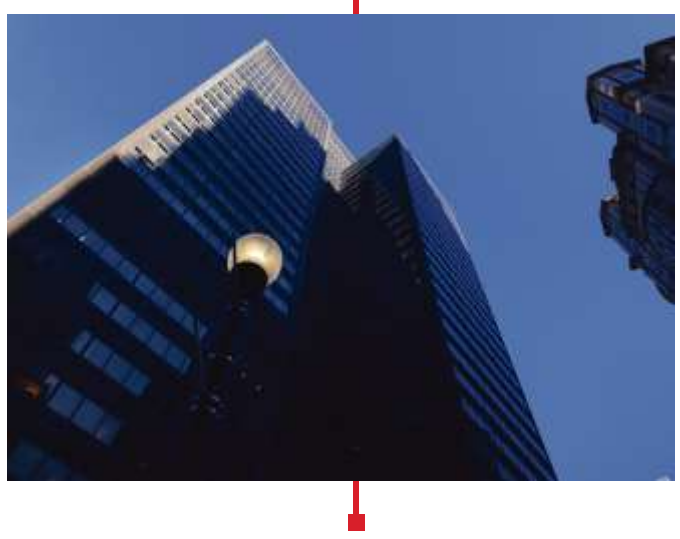
Picture this: You sign a mortgage on a big property at a choice address in Boston in 2019, just before the pandemic hits and wallops the value of your building. You spend a few years paying down the loan, then decide it doesn't make sense anymore, because the real estate is worth less than what you owe the bank.

So you default on your loan and your bank, Wells Fargo, moves to sell the 32-story tower at a foreclosure auction a few years later.

Only one bidder shows: You.

And just like that, you own the building again — for half a billion dollars less than you paid the first time.

October 2019 — Rockpoint Group purchases 100 Summer St. for
$806 million



October 2026 — Rockpoint Group buys the building after default for
$260 million

The Boston-based private equity investor Rockpoint Group pulled this off on Tuesday when it agreed to repurchase 100 Summer St. at a 68 percent discount.

Of course, an ordinary homeowner rarely gets such treatment if they default on a mortgage, which can torch their credit rating and scare off lenders in the future.

But it's not uncommon for big investors to work out a deal with their lenders when a property is "underwater." While the bank and the investors who funded the property's purchase the first time around will lose money, it's less a personal devastation and more a math problem — and one that lenders have multiple tools to solve.

A common dynamic in the

DEFAULT, Page A8

Age dictates stance on Cambridge housing

In poll, older residents are far less open to allowing taller buildings

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

Some in Cambridge are pushing to roll back the landmark zoning reform passed by the City Council last year allowing taller apartment buildings on nearly any residential lot in the housing-starved city — and a clear generational divide has emerged among residents over the measure.

Young people are mostly enthused by the idea of their streetscapes changing to make room for more homes, while older Cantabrigians are far more hesitant.

A new poll commissioned by the pro-housing groups A Better Cambridge and Abundant Housing Massachusetts found that some 86 percent of residents between the ages of 18 and 35 were at least somewhat supportive of the policy, which broadly allows four-to-six-story apartment buildings on residential land citywide. Only 38 percent of residents aged 65 and older supported the policy.

"Those who engage in community conversations around new housing are disproportionately wealthier homeowners who don't necessarily reflect the demographics broadly of their community or the desires of their community," said Jesse Kanson-Benanav, executive director of Abundant Housing Massachusetts. "It is a stark juxtaposition that those who are older and more securely housed are the ones leading the opposition to a

CAMBRIDGE, Page A6

Healey's term dominated by Trump battles

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

By 2016, Maura Healey was already a rising political star. Once an underdog candidate, she quickly built a reputation as an activist attorney general willing to fight the opioid epidemic and hospital mergers. A magazine profile deemed her "unstoppable." Insiders considered her a future gubernatorial hopeful.

Then Donald Trump was elected, and politics changed forever — and with it, Healey's profile.

The president's nationalist rhetoric and chaotic — and at times unconstitutional — policies have for years provided Healey and other Democrats the highest-profile foil possible. In a solidly blue state eager for an unyielding Trump fighter, having an opponent who's donated to Trump has provided Healey with a scapegoat at a time when many voters are frustrated over the high cost of living and other troublesome challenges plaguing the state.

"Her entire publicly elected career, this is what she's been harping on," said Sydney Asbury, a former aide to governor Deval Patrick and an adviser to Democrat Jay Gonzalez's 2018 gubernatorial campaign. "Clearly articulating [her focus] will be critical in a second term, when there is no Trump to have as a foil."

HEALEY, Page A7

Treat yourself

Friday: Beautiful. High 67-72. Low 41-46.

Saturday: A little cooler. High 52-57. Low 37-42.

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Sunrise: 7:15 Sunset: 5:40

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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Patrick Stewart, who found his greatest fame as Captain Jean-Luc Picard on "Star Trek: The Next Generation," died at 86. He had previously won acclaim as a Shakespearean actor. **C9.**

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu didn't win Israel's election. But he didn't lose, either. **A3.**

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth fired a top Army general after accusing him of leaking classified info. **A5.**

Despite colorectal cancer rising in young, there's hope

Researchers say study might lead to breakthroughs

By Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

Amid an alarming rise in colorectal cancer among younger people, researchers say they have uncovered clues about the disease that might one day lead to breakthroughs in prevention and treatments.

A team of researchers from Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, Mass General Brigham, and the Broad Institute published a study Thursday that analyzed more than 180 tumors across a wide range of ages. They examined tissue down to the cellular level and generated an extensive trove of data that provides potential insights into how the cancer might be different in younger people. Experts say the study — the largest of its kind — will be a critical resource for cancer researchers. It lays the foundation for future studies to better understand why so many young people are getting sick with more advanced and difficult-to-treat cases.

"It's been a bit of a black box," said Ana Anderson, a senior author and core faculty member of the Gene Lay Institute of Immunology and Inflammation at Brigham and Women's Hospital. "Now we

CANCER, Page A8

AN EDUCATIONAL MOMENT



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Students at the German Gerena Community School in Springfield celebrated Thursday at an event to honor Desirée Garcia, who was named the state's 2027 Teacher of the Year. The kindergarten teacher was chosen from 347 nominees. **B2.**